

● THE OPERATIONS AUDIT

12 questions to ask before adding AI to your operation.

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Most AI integrations fail before they start.

Not because the AI isn't smart enough — because the underlying operations aren't ready for it. Disorganized data produces disorganized AI. Tribal knowledge stays tribal. Manual handoffs stay manual.

These are the 12 questions we walk through with every new client before suggesting AI anywhere. Answer them honestly. If most of your answers are "I don't know" — your foundation needs work before AI can help.

Use this as a self-audit, or bring it to your next operations review.

● THE 12 QUESTIONS

Score yourself honestly.

Check the ones you can confidently answer in less than five minutes.

01. Where does each piece of operational data live today? (One source per domain or several?)
02. Is there a single source of truth — or are three systems claiming to be it?
03. Do your status fields have defined values, or does "In progress" mean four different things?
04. Can a new hire find what they need without asking a coworker?
05. What questions does leadership keep asking that take more than 5 minutes to answer?
06. What gets done by tribal knowledge that should be in a system?
07. Where are the manual handoffs where things consistently drop?
08. Which workflows depend on someone remembering — instead of a system reminding?
09. Where do approvals get stuck waiting on humans who don't know they're stuck?
10. What's your propose-vs-act boundary going to be? (Where does AI suggest, where does it commit?)
11. Who reviews AI output before it's used in a customer-facing or financial decision?
12. What happens when the AI is wrong — and how loud is the failure when it does?

● WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

Read your score.

If you confidently answered 3 or fewer:

Your operational foundation isn't ready for AI yet. That's not a problem — it's information. Layer AI on top of disorganized data and AI will give you disorganized answers. Faster, more confidently, and at scale.

Start here: clean one workflow end-to-end. Pick the one that loses the most hours to manual work. Get the data structure right. Then revisit this list.

If you confidently answered 4 to 7:

You have a partial foundation. AI can probably help with the well-documented parts, but you'll need to be selective about where it touches your operation. Read-only queries first. Write actions only after trust is built.

If you confidently answered 8 or more:

Your operation is ready. AI command centers, custom workflows, and Smartsheet-Claude MCP integrations will produce real leverage here — not novelty. Map the queries that already kill your week. Those are your first AI targets.

● WANT A WALK-THROUGH FOR YOUR OPERATION?

Book a 30-minute discovery call.

No pitch, just notes. We'll walk through your operations and tell you honestly whether what we do is a fit for your business.

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